

Setting up a Zoho Creator account and exploring the platform architecture and interface.

1. Aim

To create a Zoho Creator account, develop a sample application using forms, reports, and dashboards, and explore the platform architecture and interface for application development, deployment, and management.

2. Setting Up Zoho Creator

I) Create the Sample Application

1. Visit [Zoho Creator](#) and create/sign in to your Zoho account.
2. Open Zoho Creator and select Create Application.
3. Choose Create from Scratch or select a suitable application template.
4. Enter the application name, for example, Corporate Asset Maintenance.
5. Create the application and open the application builder.
6. Add the required components such as Forms, Reports, and Dashboards.

Create from Scratch

Name form

Create Form

II) Creating Form, Report and Dashboard

A) Creating a Form

A Form is used to collect and store data in Zoho Creator.

For the Corporate Asset Maintenance application, a form can contain fields such as:

- Name
- Phone
- Address
- Email
- Purchase Date

The screenshot displays the Zoho Creator form builder interface for an application named 'Corporate Asset Maintenance'. On the left, a 'Basic Fields' panel lists various field types: Name, Email, Address, Phone, Single Line, Multi Line, Number, Date, Time, Drop Down, Radio, Multi Select, and Checkbox. The central workspace shows a form with five fields: Name, Phone, Address, Email, and Purchase Date. The 'Purchase Date' field is currently selected, highlighted in blue. On the right, the 'Field Properties' panel for the selected field shows settings for Data Privacy, Data Security, Visibility, Appearance (Field type: Date, Field size: Medium), and Description. The bottom status bar indicates a trial period of 10 days and provides links for Upgrade, Get started faster!, and Help.

Explanation:

The form builder allows the developer to add different field types to collect information from users. Fields can be selected, arranged, edited, and deleted according to the application's requirements. In the given form, Name, Phone, Address, and Email are used to collect basic contact information.

B) Creating a Report

A Report is used to display and analyze the data collected through forms.

For the Corporate Asset Maintenance application, reports can be created to display:

- All corporate assets
- Assets due for maintenance
- Completed maintenance
- Pending maintenance
- Asset information by department

Steps to Create a Report

1. Open the Reports section.
2. Select Create Report.
3. Select the required form as the data source.
4. Choose a report format such as List, Spreadsheet, Summary, or other available formats.
5. Select the required fields.
6. Save the report.

The screenshot shows a web application titled "Corporate Asset Maintenance". On the left is a dark sidebar with a logo and navigation links: "Corporate Asset Maintenance", "Corporate Asset Maintenance", "Corporate Asset Maintenance", and "All Corporate Asset Maintenance". The main content area is a form for adding or editing an asset. The form fields are: Name (First Name: "Agarwal", Last Name: "L"), Phone (+91 8562456357), Address (Address Line 1: "Adyar", Address Line 2: "Chennai"), City / District (Chennai), State / Province (India), Postal Code, Country (India), Email (agarwal@gmail.com), and Purchase Date (01-Jul-2026). A "Submit" button is at the bottom. The top right of the application shows "Trial expires in 10 days", "Upgrade", "Edit this application", and "Help". The bottom left shows a user profile "MOHAMED..." with a search icon and a bell icon.

Explanation:

Reports provide an organized view of the records stored in the application. They help users search, filter, sort, and analyze asset and maintenance information easily.

C) Creating a Dashboard

A Dashboard provides a visual summary of important application data.

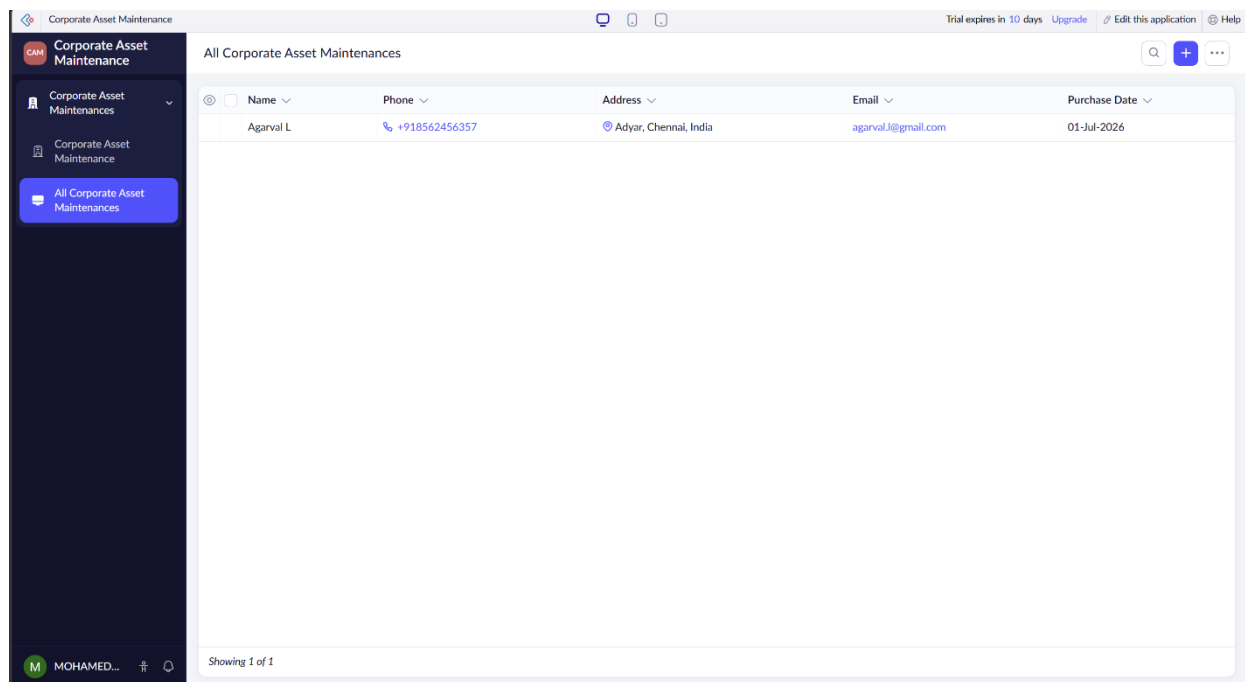
For the Corporate Asset Maintenance application, a dashboard can contain:

- Total Number of Assets
- Assets Under Maintenance
- Completed Maintenance
- Pending Maintenance
- Maintenance Status Charts
- Asset Distribution Charts

Steps to Create a Dashboard

1. Open the Pages/Dashboard section.

2. Create a new page or dashboard.
3. Add required components such as charts, reports, panels, and KPIs.
4. Connect the components to the required application data.
5. Arrange the components appropriately.
6. Save and publish the dashboard.



Explanation:

The dashboard provides a centralized visual representation of asset-maintenance information. Charts and summary components help users quickly understand the current status of corporate assets and maintenance activities.

3. Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

Zoho Creator provides three major areas for developing and operating an application: Develop, Deploy, and Manage.

A) Develop

1. The Develop section is used to build and customize applications using forms, reports, pages, workflows, and other components.

2. Developers can create data-entry forms and design reports and dashboards according to application requirements.
3. Zoho Creator also provides automation and scripting capabilities to implement application logic and workflows.

B) Deploy

1. The Deploy section is used to make the developed application available to end users.
2. Applications can be published and accessed through web and supported mobile interfaces.
3. Deployment allows users to interact with forms, reports, pages, and other application components based on their permissions.

C) Manage

1. The Manage section is used to administer and maintain the application after development and deployment.
2. Administrators can manage users, permissions, application settings, data, and other configuration options.
3. It helps monitor and maintain the application so that it continues to operate effectively.

Result

Thus, a Zoho Creator application named Corporate Asset Maintenance was created successfully. Forms, reports, and dashboards were explored, and the Develop, Deploy, and Manage sections of the Zoho Creator platform architecture and interface were studied.